

“Increasingly, business leaders believe that they cannot be successful if the community that they live and work in is not successful. So, giving back to the community is incredibly important”

the progress has been remarkable. We have impacted nearly 40 million individuals so far, and I’m confident that we will get to the 100 million number that we have committed to.

Q: Yet, take an issue like windfall taxes. On one hand, governments are saying that if you make more money as a windfall, you need to give it back to the people who need it, but there is a lot of pushback from corporations such as energy companies. How do you reconcile these two?

A: When we talk about windfall taxes, you have got to take the larger perspective. Businesses make investments so that they have a certain return and they take the risk. In return, they need certainty and if you change the rules of the game mid-stream, that is not conducive to an investment thesis. I will respond to your question with this: increasingly, it is in a business’s interest to look at all stakeholders and take a longer-term perspective. I would argue that it may be easier for a private enterprise like Deloitte than a public enterprise that has to report every quarter. But a broader view is warranted around all kinds of issues like income equality and climate. Addressing climate change is the big issue of our generation, and businesses need to take a longer-term view and ensure they are doing the right things in their business and the ecosystem.

Q: ESG has been in focus with the recent COP27 Summit where there seemed to be a lot of anger among participants who feel that the large countries and corporations are only offering lip service while kicking the can down the road, and deliberately not implementing anything which is meaningful. Is that your sense too?

A: Oh, I think businesses are cognizant of the risks that climate change poses to their business and to



society at large. You just need to look at what has happened in Pakistan with the monsoons in 2022 to grasp the enormity of the problem. The big climate events that we had all over the world in 2022 have had a direct impact because it impacts our communities, and it impacts our business directly. I think there is a clear understanding that action needs to be taken.

I can give you my example at Deloitte. When you are a \$60-billion organisation like we are, we buy a lot of stuff, and we are working with our suppliers to make sure that they are consistent with the commitments on climate change that we have made. And I have seen this happen in all the forums that I participate in across the board; businesses not only recognise that there is a climate emergency, they are making the effort required to make the change. Could it go faster? Absolutely. Does it require all hands on deck? Absolutely. This cannot be solved by the government alone; it cannot be solved by NGOs; it has to be solved by the government, NGOs and the business community together. We need to